THE MANCHESTER WAY FOR SMALL AND MEDIUM-SIZED BUSINESSES

Make AI useful.
Start with the work.

The Manchester Way treats a business as a band. Each of seven roles is one part of the work, and each has one plain question. Answer the questions, find the weakest role, and start there.

The AI Supernova is the intent to amplify what makes your business exceptional through ethical, sustainable and human-centred AI.

1 Lead singer / songwriter
The product or service and its distinctive voice.
What makes your offering yours?

2 Lead guitarist
Specialist expertise, craft and innovation.
Which capabilities make you exceptional?

3 Bass guitarist
Data.
Is your data reliable, accessible and understood?

4 Sound engineer
Systems, quality and delivery.
Does the right information reach the right people?

5 Record label
Commercial backing, investment and business model.
How do you fund and support your offering?

6 Audience
Customers and users.
Who are you performing for?

7 Reviews, applause and repeat bookings
Customer insight and measured results.
How do you hear the response?

ONE PRACTICAL ACTION PER ROLE

Seven roles. Seven first moves.

For each role, answer the question in a short team conversation, then take the first move. Each move is small enough to finish in a week.

1 **Lead singer / songwriter**

What makes your offering yours?

First move: write one sentence that says what only you offer, then test it with three customers.

2 **Lead guitarist**

Which capabilities make you exceptional?

First move: list the three things your team does better than most, and where each one shows up in your work.

3 **Bass guitarist**

Is your data reliable, accessible and understood?

First move: pick one data set you use each week, check it is complete and current, and name the person who can open it.

4 **Sound engineer**

Does the right information reach the right people?

First move: follow one order or enquiry from first contact to delivery, and mark the handover where it most often stalls.

5 **Record label**

How do you fund and support your offering?

First move: write down what one offering costs to deliver and what it earns, then name one cost to reduce or fund.

6 **Audience**

Who are you performing for?

First move: talk to five current customers. Ask what made them choose you, and what nearly stopped them.

7 **Reviews, applause and repeat bookings**

How do you hear the response?

First move: choose one measure of response, such as reviews, repeat orders or referrals, and check it at the same time every month.

HOW TO START

Start small. Learn before you expand.

Take one first move, then use the same four steps to decide what comes next.

STEP 01

Pick the weakest role

Choose the role where the answer is least clear, or where the work most often goes wrong.

STEP 02

Run one small change

Keep it to one task, one team and one measure of success.

STEP 03

Name one person in charge

One person reviews the results, handles exceptions and decides what happens next.

STEP 04

Review, then move on

Keep, change or stop the change based on what you learned. Then take the next role.

HOW WE HELP

SME workshops

Three formats: an afternoon workshop, a one-company workshop for your own team, or an open session. Workshops are self-sponsored, so your business funds its own place.

AI consultancy

Hands-on support to apply the seven questions to your own work, and to test one change before you roll it out more widely.

Keep responsibility clear. Use approved information, protect sensitive data and keep a person in charge wherever a decision matters. Do not automate a task only because a tool can do it.

GET IN TOUCH

Talk to the Manchester AI Guild

The Manchester AI Guild is a not-for-profit. It grows people, supports solution providers and connects businesses, providers and people across Manchester.

WEBSITE
manchesteraiguild.org

LINKEDIN
linkedin.com/company/manchester-ai-guild